OUNCE

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OUNCE, a little weight, the fitteenth part of a pound a- voirdupois, and the wealth part of a pound troy.

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1. Aries, or ram and ſheep, the horns of which are ſhaped like a half moon, and compreſſed. This animal is perhaps the moſt gentle and inoffenſive, and at the ſame time the moſt timid and ſtupid, of all quadrupeds. In a flock of ſheep, there is always a leader, whoſe ſteps the reſt implicitly and blindly follow. If he runs over a precipice, the whole flock follow his example, and cannot be reſtrained though evident deſtruction be the conſequence. The ſmalleſt noiſe, if uncommon, makes them run precipitantly againſt each other, without knowing the cauſe of their danger, or being able to extricate themſelves. In ſnow, they remain fixed in the ſame ſpot; and continue obſtinately in that ſituation, unleſs they are forced to move by the ſhepherd or his dog. But though daſtardly in itſelf, though almoſt devoid of ſentiment and mental qualities, this animal is of the moſt extenſive utility to man. It affords us both food and cloathing, beſides the advantages we derive from its milk, its ſkin, and its tallow.

Love, the livelieſt ſentiment in all animals, is the only paſſion which inſpires the ram with any degree of vivacity; when under the influence of this paſſion, he becomes petulant, runs againſt his neighbours, and ſometimes even attacks the ſhepherd himſelf. But the ewe, or female, though in the ſame ſituation, does not appear to be in the leaſt affected; ſhe ſeems to have no other inſtinct than that of ſimply admitting the embraces of the ram, eating her food, and recogniſing her offſpring; the lamb, on the other hand, is endowed with the ſame inſtinct of diſtinguiſhing its mother from the reſt of the flock.

This animal, ſo ſoft and ſo ſimple in its nature and diſpoſition, is likewiſe extremely weak and feeble in its conſtitution: They can endure but little fatigue; whenever they run, their hearts palpitate, and their wind fails them; they are equally incapable of bearing heat or cold, ſnow or rain: They are ſubject to many diſeaſes, moſt of which are contagious: They bring forth their young with pain and difficulty, and require more care and attention than any other domeſtic animal.

The ram is capable of generation at the age of 18 months; and the ewe can be impregnated when a year old. One ram is ſufficient for 30 or 40 ewes. He ought to be ſtrong, well proportioned; his head ſhould be thick and ſtrong, his front large, his eyes black, his noſe flat, his neck thick, his body long and tall, his teſticles maſſy, and his tail long. White is the beſt colour for a ram. The ewes whoſe wool is moſt plentiful, buſhy, long, ſoft, and white, are moſt proper for breeders, eſpecially when at the ſame time they are of a large ſize, have a thick neck, and move nimbly.

Ewes are generally in ſeaſon from the end of October to the beginning of April: However, they may be impregnated at any time, if they be fed with ſtimulating nourithment, as ſalt water, and bread made of hemp-ſeed. They go with young about five months, and generally bring forth but one at a time, though frequently two: In warm climates, they may bring forth twice in a year; but in Britain, France, and moſt parts of Europe, only once. They give milk plentifully for ſeven or eight months: Their milk affords nouriſhment for children and country people; good cheeſe is made of it, eſpecially when mixed with cow-milk. They live from 10 to 12 years, and are capable of bringing forth as long as they live.

When the male lambs are not intended to be kept for propagation, but fattened for food, they ought to be caſtrated at the age of five or ſix months. This operation is performed two ways: in the one, an inciſion is made and the teſticles taken out; in the other, a ligature is tied tight round the ſcrotum, above the teſticles, which ſoon deſtroys the veſſels which nouriſh them. After caſtration, they are called weathers.

The ram, ewe, and weather, when one year old, loſe the two foreteeth of the under jaw; ſix months afterwards, they loſe the two foreteeth next to theſe; and at the age of three years, the teeth are all replaced. The age of a ram may likewiſe be diſcovered by their horns, which always appear the firſt year, and frequently as ſoon as they are brought forth. Theſe horns uniformly acquire an additional ring every year as long as the creature lives. The ewes commonly have no horns, but a kind of long protuberances in place of them: However, ſome of them have two, and ſome four horns.

In Spain, and the ſouthern parts of Europe, the flocks are kept in ſhades or ſtables during the night: but in Britain, where there is now no danger from wolves, they are allowed to remain without, both night and day; which makes the animals more healthy, and their fleſh a more whole food. Dry and mountainous grounds, where thyme and ſheep's feſcue graſs abound, are the beſt for the paſturing ſheep.

2. The Guineenſis, or Guinea ſheep, has pendulous ears, lax hairy dew laps, and a prominence on the hind part of the head. The wool is ſhort, like that of a goat. It is a native of Guinea.

3. The ſtrepſiceros, or Cretan ſheep, has ſtrait carinated horns, twiſted in a ſpiral manner. It is a native of Mount Iola.

OULNEY, a market-town of Buckinghamſhire, ſituated nine miles ſouth-eaſt of Northampton.

OULX, a town of Italy, in the province of Piedmont, ſituated in E long. 6° 30', N. lat. 45°.

OUNCE, a little weight, the ſixteenth part of a pound avoirdupois, and the twelfth part of a pound troy.

OUNCE, in zoology. See LEO.

OUNDLE, a market-town of Northamptonſhire, ſituated on the river Nen, twenty-two miles north-eaſt of Northampton.

OVOLO, or OVUM, in architecture, a round moulding, whoſe profile, or ſweep, in the ionic and compoſite capitals, is uſually a quadrant of a circle: whence it is alſo commonly called the quarter-round.

It is uſually cut with the repreſentation of eggs and anchors or arrows heads placed alternately.

OUSE, a river, which, riſing in the north of Yorkſhire, runs ſouth-eaſt by York; and, continuing that courſe, falls into the Trent.

OUSE, is alſo a river which riſes on the confines of Oxfordſhire and Buckinghamſhire; and running north eaſt through Buckinghamſhire, Bedfordſhire, Huntingdonſhire, Cambridgeſhire, and Norfolk, paſſes by Buckingham, Bedford, Huntington, and Ely, diſcharging itſelf into the bay of the German ſea at Lynn.

OUSTIACH, or OSTIACH *Country*, is a part of Aſiatic Ruſſia, extending along the river Irtis to its confluence with the river Oby, and from thence northward along the banks of the Oby and Jeniſa, into the gulph of the Mangaſea, or the frozen ocean; and extending alſo along the

Figure 1: *
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